

PREMIUM GUIDE

KAIST

Complete Admission Guide for Indian Students

Programs, Fees, Scholarships, Placements & Campus Life

Daejeon, Daejeon

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1. KAIST at a Glance

#56 QS RANKING	1971 FOUNDED	11,000 STUDENTS	500+ INDIAN STUDENTS	94% PLACEMENT RATE
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Attribute	Details
Full Name	KAIST
Location	Daejeon, Daejeon, South Korea
Type	Public (Est. 1971)
Acceptance Rate	15%
Student-Faculty Ratio	9:1
Graduation Rate	92%
International Students	15%
Gender Ratio	35:65 (F:M)
Website	kaist.ac.kr
Motto	Korea's MIT — Asia's Innovation Powerhouse

KAIST (Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology) is South Korea's premier technical university, often called 'Korea's MIT'. With world-class research facilities and strong industry ties to Samsung, LG, and Hyundai, KAIST is the top destination for STEM-focused Indian students in Korea.

Notable Alumni

Dr. Lee Soo-man — Founder of SM Entertainment (K-pop pioneer)

2. Why Choose KAIST?

- QS #56 — Asia's top 10 engineering school
- Full scholarships + stipends for most international students
- Direct ties to Samsung, LG, Hyundai — research internships guaranteed
- English-taught programs across all departments
- Daejeon is affordable — 40% cheaper than Seoul
- South Korea's startup ecosystem is booming

| Academic Environment

Intensely research-focused. KAIST is funded by the Korean government to produce world-class scientists and engineers. The faculty includes IEEE Fellows and former industry VPs. Research output is among Asia's highest. Students are expected to publish papers.

| Student Life

Daejeon is a university town — quiet but full of students. Seoul is 50 minutes away for big-city excitement. The Indian community is small but close-knit. Korean culture is welcoming — K-pop, K-dramas, and Korean BBQ are part of daily life.

3. Programs & Courses

Popular Programs for Indian Students

Program	Level	Duration	Tuition	Highlights
MSc in Computer Science	PG	2 Years	KRW 0 (fully funded)	AI, robotics, computer vision, and systems. Fully funded with stipend.
MSc in Electrical Engineering	PG	2 Years	KRW 0 (fully funded)	Semiconductors, VLSI, communications, and embedded systems.
MS-MBA Degree	Dual PG	3 Years	KRW 0 (MS fully funded + MBA subsidised)	Technical master's + business degree for tech entrepreneurs.

4. Eligibility & Requirements

Admission Requirements

Requirement	Details
GPA	7.0+ (First Class)
GRE	Optional (recommended 310+)
IELTS	6.5+
TOEFL	83+
Work Experience	Not required
LORs	2 LORs
SOP	Required
Resume	Required
Interview	Some programs
Application Fee	KRW 0 (free!)

5. Application Deadlines

Intake	Deadline	Decision Date
Fall (Sep)	Mar 22	May 15
Spring (Mar)	Sep 20	Nov 15

6. Tuition & Cost of Living

Expense Category	Cost
Tuition (MS)	KRW 0 (fully funded for most)
Accommodation	KRW 0-4,800,000/yr
Food	KRW 3,600,000-6,000,000/yr
Transport	KRW 1,200,000/yr
Health Insurance	KRW 720,000/yr
Personal	KRW 2,400,000-4,800,000/yr

7. Scholarships & Funding

Scholarship	Amount	Eligibility	Deadline
KAIST International Student Scholarship	Full tuition + 1.2M/month stipend	KRW All admitted international students	Rolling
Global Korea Scholarship (GKS)	Full funding + airfare + settlement	Indian students through Korean Embassy	Mar 1

8. Placements & Career Outcomes

94% PLACEMENT RATE	KRW 60M AVG SALARY	KRW 120M HIGHEST SALARY	400+ COMPANIES
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Post-Study Work Pathway

E-7 visa (specialist) → F-2-7 points visa → F-5 PR | Work visa duration: Unlimited (E-7 visa renewable)

9. Campus Life for Indians

Aspect	Details
Indian Association	KAIST Indian Student Association — 150+ members
Accommodation	On-campus dormitories (free for scholarship students)
Avg Rent	KRW 200K-400K/month (free if on scholarship)
Indian Food	Taj Mahal restaurant in Daejeon, Namaste India, Indian grocery stores
Weather	4 distinct seasons — cold winters (-5°C), hot humid summers (30°C).
Transport	Daejeon Metro + KTX high-speed train to Seoul (50 min)
Healthcare	National Health Insurance (mandatory, ~KRW 60K/month)
Safety	Extremely safe. South Korea has very low crime.

Nightlife & Social Scene

Daejeon is quiet — nightlife means cafes open till late. Seoul (50 min) for clubs and bars. Most students socialise on campus or in Daejeon's Yuseong area.

Student Clubs & Societies

- **KAIST ISA** — Cultural
- **KAIST Cricket Club** — Sports
- **AI Research Society** — Tech
- **Robotics Club** — Tech
- **Startup Society** — Entrepreneurship
- **Taekwondo Club** — Sports
- **Photography Club** — Creative
- **Board Game Club** — Gaming

11. What Students Say

"Full funding + stipend + research at Samsung's level. KAIST is the best-kept secret for Indian STEM students."

— **Rahul, MSc CS '24**

"My advisor introduced me to Samsung's AI lab. I got a research internship in my first semester."

— **Priya, MSc EE '25**

"Korean BBQ at 2 AM, K-pop everywhere, and cutting-edge research. Korea is an experience like no other."

— **Vikram, MS-MBA '24**

Your KAIST Journey Starts Here

Get expert guidance on your KAIST application — SOP review, LOR templates, visa prep, and more.

www.kohortconnect.com

